

PRINCIPLES

1. Always use the "Rule of the Square" to determine if your pawn can promote before the enemy king can catch it.
2. Identify and control key squares to enhance your pawn's promotion chances.
3. Bring your king closer to the pawn to support its advance.
4. Use opposition to restrict the movement of the enemy king.
5. Avoid pushing your pawn too early; ensure your king is in a favorable position first.
6. Understand how to promote doubled pawns effectively against a king.
7. In king and pawn versus king endgames, always aim to keep your king in front of the pawn.
8. Calculate potential pawn promotions carefully before making moves.
9. Use shouldering techniques to block the opposing king's path.
10. Familiarize yourself with basic winning and drawing techniques in pawn endgames.

SITUATION

In this lesson, we discuss the right corner in a Rook vs. Bishop ending. The defender can easily hold the position from the right corner, and the lesson illustrates the winning plan of forcing the bishop out of its safe place. The key is to control the squares and prevent the opposing king from advancing.

FEN: 8/5k2/8/4P3/4K3/8/8/8 w - - 0 1

GOAL

White aims to control the squares and checkmate the black king, while Black seeks to avoid being forced into a losing position.

STRATEGY

Defend the position from the right corner, ensuring the black king cannot escape. The lesson emphasizes the importance of controlling the squares and preventing the opposing king from advancing.

MOVES

First, move your rook to f1 to force the black king out of its safe position. If the black king moves to h2, you can checkmate. The most accurate move order would be: 1. Rf1 Bh2 2. Ra7 1-0

HOW IT LINKS TO THE RULES

This lesson illustrates the importance of controlling squares and preventing the opposing king from advancing. It also emphasizes the need for careful maneuvering to maintain a defensive position.